[HIST-EVT-002] 66th Manipur Labour Corps Deployment in World War I

Translation / Context: Tangkhul Service in France During the Great War

Category: HISTORICAL_EVENT | Period: World War I | Date: 1917-1918
Place: France / Ukhrul [Ukhrul] | Dialect: Ukhrul
Source: Documented in Hodson 1911, Horam 1977, Higgins 1919 (1917)
Clearance: Public Documentation | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Key Figures: R.S. Ruichumhao, Rev. William Pettigrew (Superintendent), J.C. Higgins (Political Agent), Corps Veterans

Topography: Ukhrul to Marseille, Somme, and Arras (France) and return

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Overview: Over a thousand hillmen from Manipur, including hundreds of Tangkhuls led by R.S. Ruichumhao, volunteered for service in France, gaining broad international exposure and accelerating post-war community

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Indigenous Tangkhul Chronicle / Oral Memory:

1917 kumli Manipur Labour Corps 66th company-li Tangkhul mayarnao France
R.S. Ruichumhao-na tangkhang kaphungda maranao kathe-bingli ngashanta.
Khararamli khangatei mibing matuida thot-shir kaphung rithui kashang nga

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English Translation & Scholarly Interpretation:

In 1917, young Tangkhul men joined the 66th Manipur Labour Corps deploye
Led by interpreter and community leader R.S. Ruichumhao, they served wit
Their return home with global exposure ignited an unprecedented politica

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Chronological Milestones & Key Events:

1. 1916: British government requests auxiliary labour corps units from the Princely State of Manipur.
2. April 1917: 66th Manipur Labour Corps mobilized; over 1,200 hillmen volunteer, including 600+ Tangkhuls.
3. May 1917: Departure from Imphal via Dimapur and Bombay across the Indian Ocean and Mediterranean to Marseille, France.
4. 1917-1918: Service behind frontline trenches (road building, ammunition supply, salvage operations).

Key Tangkhul Historical Terminology:

* Mayarnao : Youth / able-bodied men of the village
* Khararam : Distant foreign land / overseas territory
* Tangkhang : Leadership / visionary guidance